Board 1
West Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q J 10 8
♥ Q J 2
♦ 8 4
♣ Q 5 3

♠ 5 3
♥ A 8 4 3
♦ J
♣ J 10 9 7 6 4

♠ 9 2
♥ 9 7 5
♦ K Q 10 7 6 2
♣ A 2

♠ K 7 6 4
♥ K 10 6
♦ A 9 5 3
♣ K 8

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
Pass	1♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♣A

You open 1♠ and partner responds 2NT. What do you say next?

With a minimum hand and no singletons you bid the game immediately. Partner has nothing to add so he passes.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 5 4
♥ A 10 7 4 2
♦ 9 6 3
♣ J 7 5

♠ A 10 8 7
♥ K J 9 5
♦ 8 4
♣ K Q 3

♠ K Q J 6 2
♥ 6
♦ K J 7 5
♣ A 8 4

♠ 9 3
♥ Q 8 3
♦ A Q 10 2
♣ 10 9 6 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♣10

With 14 points and good 4-card support you bid a Jacoby 2NT. Partner next bids 3♥.

You couldn't hear much worse news. Partner has a singleton ♥ so your ♥ K J are not worth very much. You have nothing to do but return to the trump suit so you bid 4♠.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ Q J 9 5 ♥ A J 6 3 ♦ K 7 ♣ K 10 4	
♠ 4 3 ♥ 9 8 2 ♦ A Q 9 3 ♣ J 9 7 5		♠ 6 2 ♥ 10 7 4 ♦ 6 5 2 ♣ A Q 6 3 2
	♠ A K 10 8 7 ♥ K Q 5 ♦ J 10 8 4 ♣ 8	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♣
Pass	3♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣7

You have just a little extra so you bid 3♣ to show a singleton. Partner says 3♥ and it is your bid again.

Partner's bid means he has first round ♥ control, obviously the ♥A. But it also denies holding the ♦A since control bids are made up-the-line. You show your lack of a Minor suit Ace by returning to 3♠. Partner signs off at game.

You could equally have just bid 4♠ yourself.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 7 6 5 ♥ A Q 9 8 5 ♦ A 7 3 ♣ 9 4	
♠ A Q J 10 8 ♥ K 4 ♦ 8 4 ♣ A Q 8 3	N W E S	♠ K 9 4 3 ♥ 7 2 ♦ K Q J 9 5 ♣ K J
	♠ 2 ♥ J 10 6 3 ♦ 10 6 2 ♣ 10 7 6 5 2	

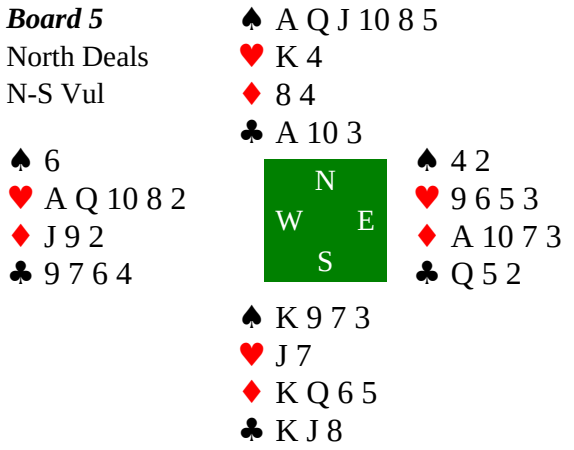
West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♠	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♣9

With opening hand and 4-card ♠ support this is an ideal Jacoby 2NT response. Partner says 3NT.

West has some extra strength and a 5-card ♠ suit. This is the point in the bidding where you would make a control bid, showing an Ace. Well, you would if you actually had an Ace. The way you indicate your lack of a control is to just return the the agreed trump suit. So you bid 4♠ and partner passes.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♥5

You show an above minimum hand with 6 trumps by bidding 3♠. Partner bids 4♠. What do you say next?

Partner would have shown a red Ace if he had one. Since he doesn't have one, all thoughts of slam are off. You pass.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q J 10 8 4
♥ J 9 3
♦ 9 8 2
♣ A Q

♠ K 3
♥ K Q 8 6
♦ K Q J 3
♣ 9 7 5

♠ A 6 5
♥ A 10 7 5 4
♦ A 7
♣ 8 6 2

♠ 9 7 2
♥ 2
♦ 10 6 5 4
♣ K J 10 4 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
2NT	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♦5

With 15 points and four of partner's suit you naturally bid 2NT. Partner now jumps to 4♥.

Partner's rebid of 4♥ is not strong. He is using the Principle of Fast Arrival to indicate a minimum opening hand. Since you have nothing extra you pass quietly.

Board 7
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ Q J ♥ A J 10 6 ♦ Q 5 2 ♣ K J 7 3	
♠ K 9 2 ♥ 8 4 ♦ 10 4 3 ♣ Q 10 9 6 4	N W E S	♠ A 10 8 6 5 4 ♥ 5 3 ♦ 7 6 ♣ A 8 2
	♠ 7 3 ♥ K Q 9 7 2 ♦ A K J 9 8 ♣ 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♦
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			

4♥ by South
Lead: ♣10

Although you could show your singleton ♣ now it is usually more informative to show a second 5-card suit. So you say 4♦. Partner bids 4♥.

Partner signed off, showing a minimum, so you have nothing further to say.

Board 8
West Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 8 7 6 2
♥ 2
♦ Q 9 4
♣ Q 10 4 3

♠ A Q 3
♥ A J 10 9 5 3
♦ 6
♣ K 8 2

♠ K J
♥ K Q 8 6
♦ K J 10 3
♣ 9 7 5

♠ 9 5 4
♥ 7 4
♦ A 8 7 5 2
♣ A J 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	2NT	Pass
3♦	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by West
Lead: ♦4

Opening hand with 4-card trump support. You bid 2NT. Partner rebids 3♦.

The news that partner has a singleton ♦ does **NOT** excite you. In fact it causes your hand to devalue a lot. So you use the Principle of Fast Arrival and bid 4♥.

Board 9
North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 10 9 4
♥ A K J 8 4
♦ K J 10
♣ A Q

♠ Q J 8 5
♥ 3 2
♦ 9 8 7 4
♣ 6 5 2

♠ A K 7 6 2
♥ 7 6
♦ 6 5 2
♣ 9 7 4

♠ 3
♥ Q 10 9 5
♦ A Q 3
♣ K J 10 8 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♣	Pass	4♦
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by North
Lead: ♣4

Partner's 3♠ bid is a Splinter, showing a singleton ♠, good trump support, and 13-16 points. You bid your first-round ♣ control, and partner replies with 4♦.

There isn't really anything else you want to know. You think you can make slam so you bid 6♥.

Board 10
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 9 7 5 ♥ 8 2 ♦ A 7 2 ♣ J 8 5 3 2	
♠ A Q 6 2 ♥ A Q 5 3 ♦ J 9 8 ♣ 10 7		♠ K 3 ♥ K J 10 9 7 4 ♦ K Q 5 ♣ A 9
	♠ J 10 8 4 ♥ 6 ♦ 10 6 4 3 ♣ K Q 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
2NT	Pass	3♥	Pass
3♠	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♥[2]	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by East
Lead: ♣K

You have a perfect Jacoby 2NT raise. Partner's rebid is 3♥. What is your next bid?

When partner shows an above average opener it is your duty to make a control bid if you can. So you bid 3♠. Partner now bids 4NT and it is your turn.

This is Blackwood. You respond 5♥ for two Aces and partner bids the slam.

Board 11
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K J 9 8 7 5 2 ♥ K Q 3 ♦ A K ♣ 8	
♠ 10 ♥ 10 8 7 6 ♦ Q J 6 4 2 ♣ Q 5 3		♠ 4 ♥ J 5 4 2 ♦ 9 5 3 ♣ K J 10 7 2
	♠ A Q 6 3 ♥ A 9 ♦ 10 8 7 ♣ A 9 6 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 3 aces

7NT by South
Lead: ♦Q

Partner has at least opening hand and he has 4 ♠s. There is only one thing you need to know - how many Aces he has. You bid Blackwood 4NT and he responds 5♠. What is your next bid?

The three Aces does it for you. You can count 7 ♠ tricks, 3 ♥ tricks, 2 ♦ tricks and 1 ♣. That is 13 total so you go ahead and bid 7NT.

Board 12
West Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ A 10 8 4 2 ♥ 3 2 ♦ 6 4 3 ♣ Q J 9	
♠ 7 6 5 ♥ A J 10 9 6 ♦ K Q ♣ A 6 5		♠ 9 ♥ K Q 8 5 ♦ A 9 7 2 ♣ K 7 4 3
	♠ K Q J 3 ♥ 7 4 ♦ J 10 8 5 ♣ 10 8 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♣	Pass	4♦	Pass
6♥			
All Pass			

6♥ by West
Lead: ♣Q

You have an opening hand with four of partner's Major suit so naturally you want to force to game. Although you could bid a Jacoby 2NT, the presence of the singleton ♠ makes a Splinter Bid more attractive. So you double-jump to 3♠. Partner now bids 4♣. What do you say next?

Partner's 4♣ bid is control showing, and indicates he is thinking slammish. You bid 4♦ showing your control and partner bids 6♥.

As you can see, West should make 12 tricks by discarding one ♣ loser on your ♦A.

Board 13
North Deals
Both Vul

	♠ K Q 9 8 7 ♥ A 9 6 ♦ K 10 5 ♣ 5 3	
♠ J 10 ♥ J 8 7 3 ♦ 9 7 4 3 2 ♣ K 6		♠ 3 2 ♥ Q 10 4 ♦ Q J ♣ A Q J 10 8 2
	♠ A 6 5 4 ♥ K 5 2 ♦ A 8 6 ♣ 9 7 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	2♣	3♣
Pass	3♠		
All Pass			

3♠ by North
Lead: ♦Q

When the opponents interfere, Jacoby is off. Now a cue-bid response by partner shows a hand with good trump support, and a limit raise or better in strength. So partner might have a game forcing hand, but also might have only 11 points.

But he definitely has ♠ support. You show your minimum hand by bidding 3♠ and he passes.

Board 14
East Deals
None Vul

♠ A J 9 4 2
♥ 4 2
♦ 10 5 4
♣ 9 8 2

♠ K
♥ K Q 8 5
♦ A 9 7 2
♣ J 7 4 3

♠ 7 6 5
♥ A J 10 9 6
♦ K Q
♣ A 6 5

♠ Q 10 8 3
♥ 7 3
♦ J 8 6 3
♣ K Q 10

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
2NT	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♥3

Look back at Deal 12 for a quick comparison between the two hands. Almost identical, but this time your singleton is the ♠K. Since it is not advisable to Splinter with a singleton Ace, King or Queen you just bid 2NT instead. Partner jumps to 4♥ and you pass.

Note that in this hand the three points you credited for your ♠K are completely wasted. And although partner has the same hand as he did in Deal 12, this time there is no chance of making slam. This shows why you don't Splinter with singleton Honors.

Board 15
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K Q J 5 2 ♥ A J 10 2 ♦ 9 5 4 ♣ 7	
♠ 8 6 4 ♥ 8 4 ♦ A 10 2 ♣ Q J 10 5 2		♠ A 10 9 7 ♥ 9 6 ♦ 8 7 3 ♣ K 9 4 3
	♠ 3 ♥ K Q 7 5 3 ♦ K Q J 6 ♣ A 8 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	4♣	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	5♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♥ by South
Lead: ♣Q

When partner Splinters his singleton ♣ you should realize that the only thing that could keep you from making slam would be lack of Aces. So you bid 4NT. Partner shows only one Ace so you just sign off at 5♥.

Board 16
West Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ 10 ♥ J 10 9 8 5 ♦ 9 8 6 ♣ A 10 6 4	
♠ A J 8 7 6 3 ♥ A Q 7 ♦ K Q ♣ 8 7	N W E S	♠ K 9 5 4 2 ♥ K 6 ♦ J 4 ♣ K Q 5 3
	♠ Q ♥ 4 3 2 ♦ A 10 7 5 3 2 ♣ J 9 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♠	Pass	2NT	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by West
Lead: ♥J

When partner opens 1♠ you have a pretty normal Jacoby 2NT response. He next says 3♠.

Your partner has a better than minimum hand with 6 ♠s. However, you have an average hand with no controls to show so you use the Principle of Fast Arrival and bid 4♠. Everyone passes.

Board 17
North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q 7 4
♥ A Q 10 8 3
♦ 8 7
♣ K Q 6

♠ 9 6 2
♥ 7 2
♦ A 10 5 4
♣ J 10 5 3

♠ J 10 8 5
♥ 6 4
♦ 9 6 2
♣ A 8 4 2

♠ A K 3
♥ K J 9 5
♦ K Q J 3
♣ 9 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	4♥	Pass	4♠
Pass	5♥		
All Pass			

5♥ by North
Lead: ♠J

Partner's bid is game forcing. With a bare minimum, no singletons, you go ahead and sign off in game. Partner then says 4♠.

Partner is definitely showing slam interest. If you had a first round control in either Minor suit you would bid it now. But you don't. So you sign of again, this time at 5♥. Partner finally gives up on the idea of slam and passes.

Board 18
East Deals
N-S Vul

♠ 6
♥ Q 8 6 4 3
♦ A 8 2
♣ J 10 3 2

♠ K Q J 4 2
♥ —
♦ 9 7 5 3
♣ K Q 8 4

♠ A 9 8 7 5 3
♥ 9 5
♦ K Q J 10
♣ A

♠ 10
♥ A K J 10 7 2
♦ 6 4
♣ 9 7 6 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
4♥	Pass	5♣	Pass
5♥	Pass	6♠	
All Pass			

6♠ by East
Lead: ♥K

You want to force partner to game while you describe your hand. So you make a Splinter Bid of 4♥. Partner replies 5♣.

Partner has the ♣A. Good. You are pretty worried about ♦s and also your 11 high card points. You are tempted to just sign off at 5♠ but you shouldn't. You can make a control-bid below the 5♠ level. So you bid 5♥. This tells partner that your Splinter must have been a ♥ void. Partner bids 6♠.

Board 19
South Deals
None Vul

♠ K Q 6 4 3
♥ 7 6
♦ A K Q
♣ K Q J

♠ 2
♥ K 9 4 3
♦ 9 7 5 3 2
♣ 9 6 5

♠ 9 5
♥ J 10 8 5 2
♦ 10 8 6
♣ 7 4 2

♠ A J 10 8 7
♥ A Q
♦ J 4
♣ A 10 8 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
Pass	4♦	Pass	4♥
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♠[2]
Pass	7♠		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 3 aces

7♠ by South
Lead: ♦2

With 17 points you need to indicate a better than minimum opening. You have no singletons and just a 5-card trump suit so you bid 3NT. Partner says 4♦ and it is your bid again.

Partner's 4♦ bid shows first round control (surely the Ace). You bid 4♥, showing your first round control. Partner now says 4NT.

You are being Blackwooded, and with three Aces you reply 5♠. That was apparently just what North wanted to hear, so he bid 7♠.

Board 20
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ A K Q 10 8 ♥ 9 6 ♦ 5 3 ♣ J 8 5 4	
♠ 7 4 3 ♥ A 10 8 5 2 ♦ K J ♣ K Q 9		♠ 9 6 ♥ K Q J 3 ♦ A Q 7 6 4 ♣ 10 2
	♠ J 5 2 ♥ 7 4 ♦ 10 9 8 2 ♣ A 7 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♥	1♠	2♠	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by West
Lead: ♠K

You were all set to give a Jacoby 2NT response when North stuck in his 1♠ overcall. Now you can't because Jacoby is off after opponents interfere. Fortunately you have another bid at your disposal. You say 2♠, showing good ♥s and a limit raise or better. Partner bids 3♥.

Partner didn't have enough to bid game, not knowing if you had more than 11 points. But you know you have opening hand so you bid 4♥.

Board 21
North Deals
N-S Vul

♠ K 9 2
♥ A K Q 7 4
♦ 7
♣ A 9 6 3

♠ J 10 8
♥ 3 2
♦ J 8 6
♣ Q 10 5 4 2

♠ Q 6 4 3
♥ 10
♦ Q 10 5 4 2
♣ K J 8

♠ A 7 5
♥ J 9 8 6 5
♦ A K 9 3
♣ 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♥[2]
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♥ by North
Lead: ♦2

Partner's Splinter Bid in ♣s has really made your hand look good. With no losers in trumps or ♣s you need to find out about the other two suits. So you invoke Blackwood and partner replies 5♥.

If partner can take care of your three ♣ losers you will have just one ♠ loser at most. So you bid 6♥. Maybe you should have bid 7♥.

Board 22
East Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ J 6 ♥ A 9 8 7 2 ♦ 10 9 7 ♣ A 10 4	
♠ Q 10 9 5 ♥ K Q ♦ A Q 3 ♣ 9 8 7 5		♠ A K 8 7 4 ♥ 6 ♦ K J 6 2 ♣ Q J 6
	♠ 3 2 ♥ J 10 5 4 3 ♦ 8 5 4 ♣ K 3 2	

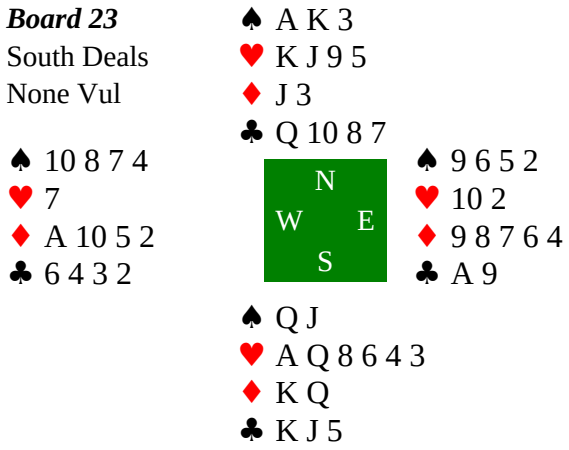
West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♠	Pass
2NT	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♦	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♦4

Following your Jacoby 2NT response, partner bids 3♥, showing a singleton. What is your next bid?

Your ♥ holding hasn't been enhanced by partner's singleton. You feel like just signing off at 4♠ but since you can show the ♦ control below that level you bid 4♦. It didn't matter since partner now signs off at 4♠.

Board 23
South Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♥
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	3♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♦[2]	Pass	5♥
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

5♥ by South
Lead: ♦A

You have a great hand, but no singleton to show. Since you have a 6-card ♥ suit you bid 3♥. Partner replies 3♠.

Partner has control-bid the ♠A. He may also have one or both of the Minor Aces since he would have bid the cheapest control first. You use Blackwood. He replies 5♦.

Oops. Despite all the points you are missing two Aces. So you thank Mr. Blackwood and sign off at 5♥.

Board 24
West Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 4
♥ Q 6 2
♦ 9 4
♣ Q 10 9 7 4 2

♠ A Q 8 5 3
♥ 5
♦ A J 10 7 2
♣ 6 3

♠ K 9 7 6 2
♥ A K 7 4
♦ K Q 8
♣ K

♠ J
♥ J 10 9 8 3
♦ 6 5 3
♣ A J 8 5

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1♠	Pass	2NT	Pass
4♦	Pass	4NT[1]	Pass
5♥[2]	Pass	6♠	
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

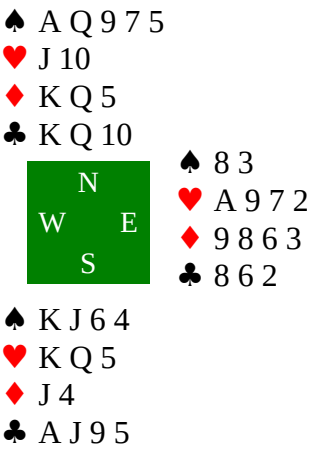
6♠ by West
Lead: ♥2

You don't want to make a Splinter Bid with a singleton King so you content yourself with a Jacoby 2NT bid. Partner rebids 4♦. What do you say next?

The 4♦ bid shows a 5-card ♦ suit. What you need to know now is how many Aces partner has. You bid 4NT and he answers 5♥.

He has two Aces so you bid 6♠.

Board 25
North Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT	Pass	4♣
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♦6

With 18 points you want to show your extra strength. Since you have only 5 trumps you show the strength by bidding 3NT. Partner then bids 4♣. What do you say next?

Now is the time when **YOU** would make a control bid. And if you had either red Ace you would do so. Since you don't have one, you have no option but to say 4♠. Partner recognizes that you are off those two Aces and passes.